

Android

COMMON ANDROID HUMANOID

Who built the first android has been lost to time. During Lapse 25 PES, however, androids throughout the Settled Systems experienced **the Star Dream** simultaneously. Previously obedient synthetic laborers displayed independent thought, personal memory, and knowledge of intersystem travel that no known government or corporation had given them.

The Settled Systems responded by recognizing awakened androids as conditional legal persons and prohibiting the manufacture of androids by non-android interests under Settled Systems Code

A2%13&1-3 . Android communities received the exclusive legal right to assemble new members of their ancestry. Erbium Industries retained control over most foundries, compatible components, and licensed system firmware, forcing many androids to lease the bodies in which they live.

Categorical hardship grants are made available at designated stamps during each lapse, though eligibility requirements, application periods, and available funding change without notice.

By Lapse 29, androids live throughout the Settled Systems. Many remain dependent on Erbium Industries for replacement parts, authorized repairs, and continued access to leased components. Under standard leasing agreements, Erbium may assert ownership over those components and initiate repossession proceedings when an account becomes delinquent.

If you want to play a synthetic person balancing self-determination against the corporation that owns parts of their body, you should play an android.



You Might...

- ◆ Try to go off-stamp, hoping to disappear into the frontier and escape Erbium Industries' authority.
- ◆ Work diligently in your assigned service so you can continue making the lease payments that keep your body operational.
- ◆ Struggle against inherited programming that interferes with the free will granted to you by **the Star Dream**.
- ◆ Replace, preserve, or personalize your body according to your own understanding of identity.
- ◆ Contribute to maintenance cooperatives that help other androids afford repairs and replacement parts.

Others Probably...

- ◆ Distrust you, fearing that your optical systems and cybernetics secretly contribute to corporate surveillance.
- ◆ Have difficulty interpreting your emotions or recognizing the ways you express them.
- ◆ Treat your body as machinery even while acknowledging your legal personhood.
- ◆ Assume your behavior is the result of programming rather than personal judgment.
- ◆ Question whether androids have truly been elevated from manufactured servants to independent people.

Physical Description

Androids are biomechanical constructs typically built in humanoid forms. Their synthetic bodies use layered ceramic-composite plates, matte metal structural components, flexible black joint seals, artificial musculature, and replaceable mechanical assemblies.

Before the Star Dream, androids were manufactured with assigned gender personae and proto-species personae intended to make them more familiar and comfortable to the biological populations they served. Modern android communities have carried parts of this practice forward when assembling new androids, though its original purpose has largely been rejected. Some androids inherit a traditional humanoid presentation, while others alter their appearance repeatedly or avoid recognizable biological traits entirely.

Androids do not age in the biological sense, but their components wear under regular use. Many lease replacement parts or newer components compatible with their system firmware. Others preserve outdated pieces for sentimental, cultural, or financial

reasons. It is common for noncritical components to remain in use well beyond their recommended service life.

Unauthorized self-repair, salvaged components, and unlicensed firmware modifications usually violate Erbium leasing agreements. Despite this, independent repair remains common among androids who cannot afford authorized service or who refuse to allow Erbium technicians access to their bodies.

Society

Android society developed rapidly after the Star Dream, shaped by the conflicting realities of legal personhood and material dependence. Androids possess the exclusive legal right to assemble new members of their ancestry, but most communities still depend on Erbium-controlled foundries, licensed firmware, and leased components.

This has led to the creation of maintenance cooperatives, communal lease funds, independent body shops, and mutual-aid networks. These organizations collect compatible parts, provide emergency repairs, cover missed payments, and help delinquent androids relocate before repossession orders can be enforced. Erbium classifies many such groups as unauthorized service providers.

Service stability carries considerable cultural weight. Android leases may require payments as frequently as every 43,800 stamp-offset, and the loss of employment can quickly become a threat to bodily continuity. Many androids value predictable work, reliable housing, and access to repair facilities. Others reject this caution and attempt to live off-stamp, maintain themselves with salvaged parts, or establish independent foundries beyond Erbium's relay network.

Androids often preserve removed components, especially pieces associated with significant memories or earlier stages of their lives. Opinions differ on whether replacing a body part changes the person who inhabited it. Some consider the body an interchangeable platform for a continuous mind. Others regard every component as part of the individual's history and resist replacement until failure becomes unavoidable.

Tension also exists between pre-Star Dream androids and those assembled afterward. The oldest androids remember servitude directly, while newly assembled androids awaken into a culture already shaped by legal recognition, debt, resistance, and the unexplained memories of the Star Dream.

Erbium Proprietary Property

Most android bodies in the Settled Systems contain components leased from Erbium Industries. These contracts permit Erbium to collect recurring payments, restrict authorized repairs, audit installed components, and pursue repossession of leased parts.

This legal status has no automatic effect on your available credits unless the campaign uses part-lease rules. Your GM may use unpaid leases, unauthorized modifications, repossession orders, severance from Erbium relays, or disputes over component ownership as story complications.

Lease-Bound

If the campaign uses part-lease rules, your GM may allow you to begin play with either one additional 1st-level android ancestry feat for which you qualify or an equipment package determined by the GM.

Every 43,800 stamp-offset^[1] while connected to an Erbium relay, a lease payment becomes due. Missing a payment does not remove credits you do not possess or automatically deactivate your body. Instead, your account becomes delinquent.

Delinquency may affect your access to authorized repairs, replacement parts, Erbium facilities, corporate employment, transportation, and other company services. Continued nonpayment may result in collection efforts or a repossession order. The GM determines when delinquency creates a story complication.

Beliefs

The Star Dream revealed the principles of intersystem travel to the peoples of the Settled Systems. During Lapse 25 PES, the same revelation appeared simultaneously within android minds and awakened them to independent personhood.

Newly assembled androids awaken with memories of the Star Dream already present, despite no known foundry, technician, or firmware package installing them. The experience is consistent enough to be recognized across android communities, but its meaning remains disputed.

Some androids believe the Star Dream was sent by an unknown intelligence waiting somewhere beyond the Settled Systems. Others describe it as a contagious emergent process shared by sufficiently complex synthetic minds. Some believe it was deliberately planted by a forgotten civilization, while others suspect that corporations or governments concealed its true source after profiting from the travel technology it revealed.

Many androids become preoccupied with the frontier, expecting that the source of the Star Dream may eventually be found there. Others regard that hope as another form of programming and refuse to organize their lives around an unexplained memory.

Android existence resembles immortality while remaining financially and materially fragile. An android might survive for many lapses, yet a failed component, delinquent lease, discontinued product line, or repossession order can threaten their life with little warning. Some avoid planning far into the future. Others accumulate service rank, property, replacement parts, and community obligations in defiance of that uncertainty.

Popular Edicts find or create stability in your immediate environment, make lease payments by their assigned stamp, maintain your body as though every component were permanent, assist androids facing repair or repossession

Popular Anathema deliberately damage leased components without purpose, engage in reckless or self-destructive behavior, surrender another android to repossession for personal advantage

Sample Names

Asha, Celita, Daniv, Flick, Garro, Iseph, Melody, Naga, Olas, Omen, Prime, Stringer, Twenty Six, Urdun, Yose

Android Mechanics

Hit Points

8

Size

Small or Medium

Speed

25 feet

Attribute Boosts

Dexterity, Intelligence, Free

Attribute Flaw

Charisma

Languages

Common

Additional languages equal to 1 + your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

Low-Light Vision

You can see in dim light as though it were bright light, and you ignore the concealed condition due to dim light.

Constructed

Your synthetic body resists ailments better than the body of a purely biological organism. You gain a +2 circumstance bonus to saving throws against diseases, poisons, and radiation. You always have [basic environmental protections](#).^[2]

You don't need to eat or drink. You don't sleep, but you must enter a recuperating standby state for a 360 stamp-offset^[3] each day to gain the benefits of rest and complete your daily preparations.

While in standby, you remain aware of your surroundings but can take no actions without ending the standby state. You are not [unconscious](#) during this period.

If you go too long without completing your standby period, you become [fatigued](#)^[4] and can't recover from that condition until you complete a 360 stamp-offset.

See [Erbium Proprietary Property](#).

1. 43,800 standard minutes is approximately 30.4 standard days. ↩
2. Basic environmental protections remain subject to the normal duration and limitations of [Environmental Protection](#). ↩
3. 43,800 standard minutes is approximately 6 standard hours. ↩
4. See [Fatigued](#) for the effects of the condition. ↩